Functionalists are regarded as piecemeal social engineers and not the architect or purveyors of blueprints. Claude[9] is critical about the length of time involved in the process of bringing about integration. He says that "Functionalism is not in a hurry, and its claim to offer hope to the world is implicitly based upon the supposition that a long period is both necessary and available for working out solutions to the problems". Many scholars fail to acknowledge the fact that cooperation exists in the social and economic fields; in other words, the non-political sectors. However, such kind of separation between high politics and low politics is hardly tenable. Political issues seem to shape the social or economic activities of the structures of the international system. As Kegley and Wittkopf[10] point out that "the reality is that technical cooperation is often more severely impacted by political considerations than the other way around. The withdrawal from and the subsequent re-entry of the United States into the International Labour Organization (ILO) because of the politicized nature of the organization dramatized the primacy of politics. Indeed, functionalism makes the naive assumption that technical (functional) undertakings and political affairs can be separated. They cannot".

Despite such criticisms, it cannot be denied that functionalism was perhaps the inspiration behind the integrative process in Europe and also the functioning of international organizations like the United Nations along with its specialized agencies.

Neo-Functionalism

Taking cue from functionalism and the experience of Western Europe, theorists of international relations have used the term 'integration' to denote either a 'process' towards or an end product of political unification among separate national units. Neo-functionalism arose as a critique of functionalism, along with the publication of most celebrated works of Ernst B. Hass's *Beyond the Nation-State: Functionalism and International Organization* and *The Uniting of Europe: Political, Social, and Economic Forces, 1950–1957*, and Karl Deutsch and his associates' *Political Community and the North Atlantic Area* and *France, Germany and the Western Alliance: A*